

VIDEO GAME DESIGN

2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ PDF of the documentation portfolio was submitted
- ☐ Video game is accessible and playable online
- ☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

VIDEO GAME DESIGN (60 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance 1-4 points	Adequate performance 5-8 points	Exemplary performance 9-10 points	
Creativity and Artwork (X1)	The game lacks creativity and originality; little effort is evident in the quality of the artwork.	The game is original and exhibits adequate creativity and artistic quality.	The game is original, highly creative, and well crafted; artwork and graphics contribute to the enjoyability of the game.	
Technical Skill (X1)	The game lacks evidence of programming skills.	The game shows some evidence of programming skills.	The game shows strong evidence of programming skills.	
Storyline/Flow of the Game (X1)	The game follows little or no storyline; there is little to no logical flow to the game.	The game follows a storyline and flows adequately from one (1) scene/level to another.	The game is well-organized and flows smoothly from one (1) scene/level to the next, enhancing the game play.	
Game Mechanics (X1)	The game lacks appropriate use of game mechanics; little feedback is provided to the player, the controls are difficult to use, and/or the objectives of the game are unclear.	The game has adequate use of game mechanics and there is some evidence care in the design of player feedback, objectives, or player controls.	The game has exemplary use of game mechanics and there is evidence of significant consideration placed on the design of player feedback, objectives, and controls.	
Overall Appeal (X2)	Playing the game is not enjoyable, dull, and/or monotonous; interacting in game play is a struggle.	The game is somewhat interesting, easy, and enjoyable to play; most game design concepts are incorporated.	The game is innovative and entertaining; design principles are incorporated, which make playing the game easy and enjoyable.	
VIDEO GAME DESIGN SUBTOTAL (60 points)				

DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO (70 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Portfolio Components (X1)	Portfolio is unorganized and/or is missing three (3) or more components.	Portfolio is missing one (1) or two (2) components and/or is loosely organized.	Portfolio has all required components in order and is well organized.	
Game Directions, Control Functions, and Market Research (X1)	The game explanation is difficult to follow; no market research is provided; functions provided are illogical or incorrect.	The game directions can be followed and generally sync with overall workings of the game; some market research is provided; most control functions match the functions of the game.	The game explanation is easy to follow, market research is thorough, and control functions clearly match the game functions.	
Storyboard (X2)	The storyboard is sloppy, disorganized, and incomplete and/or does not follow overall flow of the game design.	The storyboard is generally organized and includes aspects and overall scenes of the game.	The storyboard is complete, concise, neat, and follows the overall flow of the game.	
Video (X2)	The video is missing details and content and appears to be lacking information; minimum effort appears to have been given.	The video provides adequate information and includes some of the necessary information for completing the three levels.	The video is clear and concise and includes all of the necessary information for completing the three (3) levels	
Work Log (X1)	Log is poorly organized and/or incomplete.	Log is adequately detailed and organized and contains most of the required components.	Log is well documented and contains all the required components.	
DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO SUBTOTAL (70 points)				

TIME DEDUCTIONS	
A deduction of five (5) points total will be incurred for a game that completes under the three (3) minute time minimum.	
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____	

PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (130 points)	
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SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW (50 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Organization (X1)	Participants seem unorganized and unprepared for the presentation; illogical explanation of the game is presented.	Participants are generally prepared for the presentation; explanation of the game is communicated and generally organized.	The presentation is logical, well organized, and easy to follow; the game explanation is communicated in an organized and concise manner.	
Knowledge (X2)	Participants seem to have little understanding of the concepts in their project; answers to questions may be vague.	Participants exhibit an understanding of the concepts in their project.	Participants show clear evidence of a thorough understanding of their project.	

SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW (50 points) – continued			
Articulation (X1)	Communication of the design process is unclear, unorganized, and or illogical; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are not evident.	Communication of the design process is somewhat logical and clear; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are somewhat evident.	Communication of the design process is clear, concise, and logical; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are clearly evident.
Team Participation (X1)	The majority of the delivery is made by one (1) member of the team; the partner(s) may be disengaged in the presentation.	Team members are generally engaged in the presentation, though one (1) member may take on more responsibility than the other(s).	All team members are actively involved in the presentation and responses to questions; there is shared responsibility among team members.
SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW SUBTOTAL (50 points)			
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____			
SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (50 points)			
BONUS (10 points)			
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points
Bonus Points Unique and exceptional features (X1)	The game demonstrates some unique and exceptional features and/or exemplary educational value.	The game is very good but limited in uniqueness.	The game is outstanding and unique.
To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary. TOTAL (180 points)			

Record scores
in the column
spaces below.

Comments:

I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

JUDGE

Printed name: _____ Signature: _____